

COURSEMATERIAL

SUBJECT	COMMUNICATIVE ENGLISH & EG23AHS101
UNIT	I
COURSE	B.TECH
SEMESTER	I-I
DEPARTMENT	ENGLISH
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1. COURSE OBJECTIVES

The objectives of this course are to

1. Facilitate effective listening skills for better comprehension of academic lectures and English spoken by native speakers
2. Focus on appropriate reading strategies for comprehension of various academic texts and authentic materials
3. Help improve speaking skills through participation in activities such as role plays, Discussions and structured talks/oral presentations
4. Impart effective strategies for good writing and demonstrate the same in summarizing, writing well organized essays, record and report useful information
5. Provide knowledge of grammatical structures and vocabulary and encourage their appropriate use in speech and writing

2. PREREQUISITES

Students should have knowledge on

1. Enhancing communication skills.
2. Learning LSRW Skills and vocabulary.

1. SYLLABUS

2. UNIT I

Lesson: Human Values: The Gift of Magi (Short Story)

Listening: Identifying the topic, the context and specific pieces of information by listening to short audio texts and answering a series of questions.

Speaking: Asking and answering general questions on familiar topics such as home, family, work, studies and interests; introducing oneself and others.

Reading: Skimming to get the main idea of a text; scanning to look for specific pieces of information.

Writing: Beginnings and endings of paragraphs - introducing the topic, summarizing the main idea and/or providing a transition to the next paragraph.

Grammar and Vocabulary: Parts of Speech, Prepositions, Word formation-I: Introduction to Word formation, Clauses and Sentences.

3. COURSE OUTCOMES

1. Understand the context, topic, and pieces of specific information from social or transactional dialogues. (L2)
2. Apply grammatical structures to formulate sentences and correct word forms. (L3)
3. Analyze discourse markers to speak clearly on a specific topic in informal discussions. (L4)
4. Evaluate reading/listening texts and to write summaries based on global comprehension of these texts. (L5)
5. Create a coherent paragraph, Essay, and Resume. (L6)

4. Co-PO/PSO Mapping

ON THE CONDUCT OF LIFE	PO 1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO 6	PO 7	PO 8	PO 9	P10	PO11	PO12	PSO 1	PSO 2
CO1									2	2				
CO2									2	2				
CO3									2	2				
CO4									2	2				
CO5									3	3				

5. LESSON PLAN

LECTURE	WEEK	TOPICS TO BE COVERED	REFERENCES
1	1	Introduction	T1
2		Theme of the lesson	T1, R1
3		Explanation of the lesson	T1, R1
4		Textual Exercises	T1
5		Grammar and vocabulary	T1

6	2	Content words and function words	T1, R1
7		Word-forms	T1, R1
8		WH-questions–Synonyms & Antonyms	T1

6. ACTIVITY BASED LEARNING

1. Enhancing speaking skill through individual activity.
2. To improve public speaking ability through group activities.

7. LECTURE NOTES

INTRODUCTION

O. Henry (1862 - 1910) was an American short story author whose real name was William Sydney Porter. Henry's rich canon of work reflected his wide-range of experiences and is distinctive for its witticism, clever wordplay, and unexpected twist endings.

Summary of the lesson "The Gift of the Magi"

The Gift of the Magi is a well-known short story by American short story writer O. Henry, the pen name of William Sydney Porter. The story first appeared in The New York Sunday World on December 10, 1905 and was later published in O. Henry's collection The Four Million on April 10, 1906.

The story tells of a young married couple, James, known as Jim, and Della Dillingham. It's a day before Christmas Eve, a young woman named Della sitting at home counting her savings. The home she lives in with her husband, Jim, is a cheap, furnished rental apartment. When they first moved in, Jim was earning more money, but the couple has fallen on hard times and now lives in poverty. Della has been putting money aside after buying groceries for many months. She is sad and anxious because despite her efforts, she has not saved enough money. She had been hoping to buy Jim something special for Christmas with her savings. Della begins to cry on her couch as she realizes she does not have enough money to buy Jim a Christmas present.

After she stops crying, Della cleans up her face and looks out the window lost in thought. She suddenly catches a glimpse of herself in the dressing mirror on the wall and gets an idea. She lets down her long brown hair and looks at it for a little while. Della's hair, notable for its beauty, is her prized possession. She puts on her old coat and hat and visits a shop that buys and sells hair. The shopkeeper, Madame Sofronie, agrees to cut and buy Della's hair. Della

spendstherestofthedaygoingaroundthecitylookingfortheperfectgiftfor Jim.Hisprizedpossessionisagoldpocketwatchthathasbeenpasseddown throughhisfamily.Shewantstobuyhimanicechaintogowithit,something specialandrare.Eventually,shefindstheperfectplatinumchain.Itcostsall themoneyshegotfromsellingherhair,plusmostofhersavings.Dellagoes homefeelingveryexcitedtogiveJimhispresent.

WhenDellagetshome,shetriestostylehernewhaircutasbestshecan.She worriesthatJimwillbeangryandwillnolongerthinksheispretty.WhenJim seesDellahascutherhair,hegetsastrangelookonhisface.Notknowing whatitmeans,Dellagoestohimandquicklyexplainsthatshesoldherhair tobuyhimaChristmaspresent.Inresponse,Jimhugsherandtellshehe loveshernomatterwhatherhairlookslike.

HethengivesheraChristmaspresent:asetofjeweledtortoiseshellcombs she'donceadmiredinashopwindow.Dellalovesthepresent,butshebursts intotearswhensherealizessheisunabletouseJim'sthoughtfulgift.

AsJimcomfortsher,shereassureshimherhairwillgrowbackquickly.She thenexcitedlygiveshimtheplatinumwatchchain.Jimlaughsandrevealshe soldhisprizedwatchtopayforthecombs.Thenarratorendsthestory praisingthecouplefortheirselflessgiftsoflove,callingthemevenwiserthan magi,orthethreewisemenwhobroughtgiftstothebabyJesusonthefirst Christmas Eve.

by

Speaking

Speaking skills are necessary and important in many ways in academic and professional contexts. It allows us to form connections, influence decisions, and motivate change. Without communications skills, the ability to progress in the working world and in life, itself, would be nearly impossible. Speaking English allows you to actually broaden your world, from job opportunities to the ability to relate to people from every country. Knowing the language makes it much more interesting every trip.... Education is very important to improve yourself but learning English also improves the quality of life.

Introducing Oneself and Others

In this section, it will help you learn how to say who you are after greeting someone who does not know you. You will also learn how to respond to introductions.

Useful points to remember:

Here are some general guidelines to keep in mind when introducing you to others.

- Be brief and clear when you introduce yourself.
- Give your first name alone in informal situations and your full name in formal ones.
- Say where you work or give you other background information in a simple manner, without sounding boastful.
- In both formal and informal situations, do not use the honorific's professor, Dr, Mr. or Ms before your own name.
- For example, you do not say 'I'm Mr/Ms/Dr/ Professor Manu Shah'. Instead, you simply say: 'I'm Manu/Sham'. Note, however, that you may say 'I'm Mrs. Shah' if the honorific Mrs is applicable to you.

What are the advantages of speaking skills?

- Career advancement
- Boost confidence
- Critical thinking
- Personal development
- Improve communication skills
- Make new social connections
- Personal satisfaction
- Expand your professional network

General Conversations:

Example: 1

1. Conversation at the bank (telephone banking)

Executive: What would you like to know?

Customer: Can you tell me how the telephone banking services work?

Executive: You can do all your day-to-day banking over the Telephone, 24 hours a day.

Customer: That's great. How do I access my account?

Executive: Just call the bank, key in your PIN and listen to the menu.

Customer: Thank you sir.

Executive: Your welcome, Thanks for calling.

Example: 2

Doctor and patient

Patient: May I come in, sir?

Doctor: Yes come in. What's wrong with you?

Patient: I've got a sore throat with fever.

Doctor: How long have you had it?

Patient: Oh, about a week.

Doctor: It's nothing serious. You've got flu.

Patient: I'm having trouble to eat.

Doctor: I'll give you some medicine. You'll be cured soon.

Patient: Thank you.

Doctor: That's all right, take care.

Reading Skills

Definition: Reading is a method of communication that enables a person to turn writing into meaning. It allows the reader to convert a written text as a meaningful language with independence, comprehension and fluency, and to interact with the message.

Reading skill refers to the ability to understand written text. Reading is one of the most important ways of knowing the world around us. Reading influences us in the following ways: Reading helps us expand our mind. Reading helps us know who we are, what is important to us, and it helps us understand the world around us. The purpose of reading is to connect the ideas on the page to what you already know. If you don't know anything about a subject, then pouring words of text into your mind is like pouring water into your hand.

Techniques of Reading:

Reading is a great habit that can change human life significantly. The ability to read is as important today as it ever was. It can entertain us, amuse us and enrich us with knowledge and experiences narrated. There exist some reading techniques, which if mastered at a growing stage can help us, be better and far more comprehensive readers.

The two main types of reading techniques are the following:

1. Skimming
2. Scanning

Skimming refers to the process of reading only main ideas within a passage to get an overall impression of the content of a reading selection.

How to Skim:

- Read the title.
- Read the introduction or the first paragraph.
- Read the first sentence of every other paragraph.
- Read any headings and sub-headings.
- Notice any pictures, charts, or graphs.
- Notice any italicized or bold face words or phrases.
- Read the summary or last paragraph.

Scanning is a reading technique to be used when you want to find specific information quickly. In scanning you have a question in your mind and you read a passage only to find the answer, ignoring unrelated information.

How to Scan:

- States the specific information you are looking for.
- Try to anticipate how the answer will appear and what clues you might use to help you locate the answer. For example, if you were looking for a certain date, you would quickly read the paragraph looking only for numbers.
- Use headings and any other aids that will help you identify which sections might contain the information you are looking for.
- Selectively read and skip through sections of the passage.

Writing

In general, you should capitalize the first word, all nouns, all verbs (even short ones like is), all adjectives, and all proper nouns. That means you should lowercase articles, conjunctions, and prepositions—however, some style guides say to capitalize conjunctions and prepositions that are longer than five letters.

Or

When editing any piece of writing, you should check if you have used capital (or upper-case) letters correctly. Besides using it for the first letter of the opening word of a sentence, there are other conventions for the use of capital letters.

When do we Use Capital Letters?

1. Use a capital letter for the personal pronoun 'I':
 - What can I say?
 - I will stay here.
2. Use a capital letter to begin a sentence or to begin speech:
 - The man arrived. He sat down.
 - Suddenly Mary asked, "Do you love me?"
3. Use capital letters for many abbreviations and acronyms:
 - G.M.T. or GMT (Greenwich Mean Time)
 - N.A.T.O. or NATO (North Atlantic Treaty Organization)
4. Use a capital letter for days of the week, months of the year, holidays:
 - Monday, Tuesday
 - January, February
 - Christmas
 - Armistice Day

5. Use a capital letter for countries, languages & nationalities, religions:
 - China, France
 - Japanese, English
 - Christianity, Buddhism
6. Use a capital letter for people's surnames, initials and actual names, titles:
 - Anthony, Ram, William Shakespeare
 - Professor Jones, Dr Smith
 - Captain Kirk, King Henry VIII
7. Use a capital letter for trade-marks and names of companies and other organizations:
 - Pepsi Cola, Walkman
 - Microsoft Corporation, Toyota
 - the United Nations, the Red Cross
8. Use a capital letter for places and monuments:
 - London, Paris, the Latin Quarter
 - the Eiffel Tower, St Paul's Cathedral
 - Buckingham Palace, the White House
 - Oxford Street, Fifth Avenue
 - Jupiter, Mars, Sirius
 - Asia, the Middle East, the North Pole
9. Use a capital letter for names of vehicles like ships, trains and spacecraft:
 - the Titanic
 - the Orient Express, the Flying Scotsman
 - Challenger 2, the Enterprise
10. Use a capital letter for titles of books, poems, songs, plays, films etc:
 - War and Peace
 - If, Futility
 - Like a Virgin The Taming of the Shrew
 - The Lion King, Gone with the Wind
11. Use capital letters (sometimes!) for headings, titles of articles, books etc, and newspaper headlines:
 - HOW TO WIN AT POKER
 - Chapter 2: CLINTON'S EARLY LIFE
 - LIFE FOUND ON MARS!
 - MAN BITES DOG

Punctuation

Punctuation is the system of signs or symbols given to a reader to show how a sentence is constructed and how it should be read. Sentences are the building blocks used to construct written accounts. They are complete statements. Punctuation shows how the sentences should be read and makes the meaning clear. Punctuation is used to bring clarity and meaning to writing.

Types of Punctuation:

There are fifteen basic punctuation marks in English grammar. These include the period, comma, exclamation point, question mark, colon, semicolon, bullet point, dash, hyphen, parenthesis, bracket, brace, ellipsis, quotation mark, and apostrophe. Some common punctuation marks are:

- period (full stop) (.)
- comma (,)
- question mark (?)
- exclamation mark (!)
- colon (:))
- semicolon (;)
- single quotation marks (‘ ’)
- double quotation marks (‘ ‘ ’ ’)
- parentheses (), brackets [] and braces { }
- hyphen (-)
- endash (—)
- emdash (—)
- ellipsis (...)
- apostrophe (‘)
- slash (/)

1. The Period (.)

- The period is the best-known punctuation mark in writing. This particular mark is used at the ending of a sentence.
- It is designed to keep sentences from running on into long passages. Periods were not used that often in the past.

Here are some examples of how to use a period:

- The couple went to the movies to see the latest superhero film.
- The young lady had a graduation party.

2. The Question Mark (?)

- When people write questions they need a way to make them different from a standard sentence.
- Remember, a standard sentence just relays information or facts, just explain something or tell people what is happening.

Here are some examples of how to use a question mark:

- How many times did I tell you to clean your room?
- Did you go to work today?
- Who is the president on a one-hundred-dollar bill?

3. The Exclamation Point (!)

- The exclamation point simply alerts a reader that someone is angry, shouting, really upset, giving someone or something a command, threatening, startled or they are trying to emphasize something. [\[External Link\]](#)

Here are some examples

- America is a materialistic country!
- I told you to get off my lawn before I call the police!
- Bro, you talking to me! You about to get dealt with

4. The Comma(,)

- The comma separates elements and ideas within a sentence. They are used to keep separate words or pieces of information from running together. There are multiple ways to use commas. The three basic ways will be presented here.

Here are some examples of how to use commas:

- Mindy played outside, ate ice cream with her dog and played on her computer until midnight.
- Jeremiah, can you come here, please? I want to tell you that I'm sorry.
- My team scored 12 goals, and I made 10 of them.

5. The Semicolon(,)

- The semicolon is designed to join to separate clauses.

Here are some examples:

- I will go to the coffee shop; Frenchespresso is my favorite drink.
- The kids like to eat eggs and toast in the morning; make sure to use cheese with the eggs.

6. The Colon(:)

- It is often used for emphasis, when joining two sentences where the second emphasizes the first and after a word that introduces an explanation, quotation, series or example.

Here are some examples of how to use semicolons:

- I will go to the store: when I get out of bed.
- She loved only one thing more than her husband: her blueberry popsicles.
- He had to gather supplies for his garden: spade, flower pots, seeds, and a rake.

7. The Dash(–)

- The dash is used to separate words into statements. There are two types of dash. One type is known as “en” and the other is known as “em”.

Here is an example for each one:

- From 1883–1897, the evil vampires raged through the land turning everyone into the undead. This example is for the end dash.
- The New Jersey Gamblers football team is the greatest in the world— no one can beat them! This is the “em” dash and it is often used to emphasize a point.

8. The Hyphen (–)

- The hyphen is used to join certain words together.

For example:

- 10-years-old, part-time, well-known.

9. The Bracket ([])

- The bracket is used for emphasis.

Here is an example of how to use a bracket:

- That [mean boy] ate my Takis and I was very mad.

10. The Braces ({ })

Braces are often utilized by writers to show that certain information belongs together. They are not commonly used in basic writing [External Link].

- Here is an example of how to use braces:
- The configuration of the mathematical formula is displayed as $\{3n(e=mc^2) \times 8.5\% [4 + 6.8^4]\}$ rounded to the nearest cube.

11. The Parenthesis ()

- Parentheses are typically used for qualifying marks. They are also used to contain further thought.

Here is an example for parenthesis:

- The ugly cat (who roams the street in the daytime) likes to sneak into homes and bite people's dogs.

12. The Apostrophe (')

- When a writer wants to omit letters from a word, display the possessive case of a word or form the plural of a lowercase letter; they use the apostrophe.

Here are some examples for the apostrophe:

- That kid's parents are really mean.
- Don't bite the hand that feeds you.

13. The Quotation Mark (" ")

- Quotation marks are used to emphasize unusual words or they can be utilized for quoting a person or show the beginning or end of a passage.

Here are some examples of quotation marks:

- "Justin, I need you now." Said Selena as she woke up from her dream.
- Those people are every "politically correct" if you know what I mean.

14. The Ellipse (...)

- Ellipses help to keep writing brief and they are also used to jump from one phrase to another.

Here are some examples of how to use an ellipse:

- "I told you, that I want to nag at you all day and furthermore..."
- The woman nagged her husband all day, all night when he ate dinner when he... until he could no longer tolerate her presence.

Exercises:

Punctuate the following sentences correctly. Capitalize words where required.

1. I speak Telugu and Hindi better than English. What about you?
2. I need an assistant who can do the following input data, write reports and complete tax forms.
3. Who's there? Oh, it's you.
4. The Ganga is considered a holy river by the Hindus. Its source is the Gangotri glacier in the Himalayas and it empties into the Bay of Bengal in eastern India.
5. I drove my rusty old green ambassador back home as it chugged slowly down the street, its engine grunting and wheezing, its wheels wobbling all the way. I realized it was time to buy a new car.

Parts of speech

Noun:

A noun is a word that is used to identify a name, place, animal, thing or an idea. There are different types of nouns such as:

i. Proper Noun

e.g.: Proper noun is a name that identifies a particular person, place or things. It begins with a capital. John, London, January, etc..

ii. Common Noun

e.g.: A common noun is a noun that refers to people or things in general. Like Car, Dog, Chair, etc...

iii. Collective Noun

Eg: Collective nouns refer to groups of people or things. Like Bunch, audience, flock, group, family, dozen etc...

iv. Compound Noun

Eg: made up of two or more nouns combined together. like Blackboard, textbook, classroom, etc...

v. Abstract Noun

Eg: Something that you cannot perceive with your five senses, like Belief, love, pride, happiness etc...

Pronoun:

A pronoun is used in place of a specific noun mentioned earlier in a sentence so that you don't have to keep saying/writing that particular noun.

Types of pronoun:

1. Personal Pronoun - I, you
2. Relative Pronoun - who, that
3. Demonstrative Pronoun - this, that
4. Reflective Pronoun - myself, yourself
5. Interrogative Pronoun - who, which
6. Emphatic Pronoun - myself, herself
7. Indefinite Pronoun - some, anyone
8. Distributive Pronoun - each, every
9. Possessive Pronoun - mine, yours, hers

Adjective:

An adjective is a word that describes a noun or pronoun such as a person, place, thing, or idea.

An adjective can tell color, size, shape, taste, odor, texture, sound, number, weather, etc...

Verb:

Verbs almost always come after a noun or pronoun. These nouns and pronouns are referred to as the subject. The verb should come after the noun.

Examples:

1. Mark ate his dinner quickly.
2. We went to the market.
3. You write neatly in your notebook.

Regular and Irregular Verbs:

A regular verb is any verb whose conjugation follows the typical pattern, or one of the typical patterns, of the language to which it belongs. A verb whose conjugation follows a different pattern is called an irregular verb.

Regular verbs			Irregular verbs		
Present	Past	P. Participle	Present	Past	P. Participle
Act	Acted	Acted	bear	bore	Born
Bake	Baked	Baked	Befall	befell	Befallen
Die	Died	Died	fall	fell	Fallen
Fry	Fried	Fried	fly	flew	Flown
Jump	Jumped	Jumped	forget	forgot	Forgotten
Match	Matched	Matched	bite	bit	Bitten

Adverb:

Definition: An adverb describes a verb, an adjective or another adverb. It tells us how, where, when, how much, and with what frequency. eg: it tells us adverb of time, place, manner and frequency.

Prepositions:

Simple Prepositions: These are most commonly used prepositions.

Ex: - At, in, into, for, from, of, off, on, out, till, to, up, with, through, down, by, etc.

Conjunctions:

A conjunction is a word which connects two words or clauses or sentences/phrases and shows the relation between them. They are used to avoid making the text seem like the bullet points and to make the text flow.

Eg: Because, although, but, besides, unlike, therefore, provided, unless, since, so, if, yet, etc...

Basic English Sentence Patterns:

A. When we make simple English sentences, we usually follow the Subject-Verb-Object pattern

Steps:

1. Put the subject and the adjectives such as 'fat', 'thin' etc. or any words describing the subject at the beginning of the sentence
2. Put the verb and some adverb such as 'often', 'usually' etc. after the subject
3. Put the object of the verb, the adjectives or other words describing the object and the adverbs describing the verb at the end of the sentence.

Here are examples of sentence patterns:

Sentence Patterns	Examples
Subject + Verb	The bell rang. He wept.
Subject + Verb + Object	She likes eggs. I met my brother.
Subject + Verb + Adjective	Martin is busy. She was sick.
Subject + Verb + Adverb	The truck came here. He ran fast.
Subject + Verb + Noun	They are teachers. Marilyn was the class president.

Exercise 1:

Rearrange the words in correct order to make complete sentences.

E.g. the fat cat / a mouse / is chasing.

The fat cat is chasing a mouse.

1. that thing girl / is drinking / milk now
2. the robbers yesterday / the police / caught
3. our teacher / like / we
4. my mother / my baby sister / is looking after
5. has just written / a letter / the tall man
6. the students / have solved / some Mathematics problems
7. here aunt tomorrow / will visit / Mary
8. newspaper every day / my boss / reads
9. enjoyed / the movie / the audience
10. the cook / some chocolate cakes / has made

Answers:

Exercise 1

1. That thing girl is drinking milk now.
2. The police caught the robbers yesterday.
3. We like our teacher.
4. My mother is looking after my baby sister.
5. The tall man has just written a letter.
6. The students have solved some Mathematics problems.

7. Mary will visit her aunt tomorrow.
8. My boss reads newspaper every day.
9. The audience enjoyed the movie.
10. The cook has made some chocolate cakes.

TYPES OF QUESTIONS

In English, there are two main types of questions which are;

- Yes/No Questions
- Wh-Questions

YES/NO QUESTIONS

Yes/No questions are the questions which are answered yes or no. It means when we are asking yes/no questions, we are expecting the answer, yes or no.

To form Yes/No questions, we use one of these verbs: auxiliary verbs (be, do and have) or modal verbs (can, may, etc.).

We cannot use question words like what, how, why, who, etc. while making Yes/No questions.

QUESTION	AFFIRMATIVE SHORT ANSWER	NEGATIVE SHORT ANSWER
Are you...?	Yes, I am.	No, I'm not.
Is she...?	Yes, she is.	No, she's not.
Do you...?	Yes, I do. / Yes, we do.	No, I don't. / No, we don't.
Does he...?	Yes, he does.	No, he doesn't.
Can we...?	Yes, we can.	No, we can't.
Have you got...?	Yes, I have. / Yes, we have.	No, I haven't. / No, we haven't.
Has he got...?	Yes, he has.	No, he hasn't.
Would you like...?	Yes, I would. / Yes, we would.	No, I wouldn't. / No, we wouldn't.

WH –questions

There are number of words in the English language that are used primarily to make questions; these words are 'question words', sometimes known as 'WH question words'.

What	What is used when asking for information about something: What did you do last evening?
When	When is used when asking for the time: When did you arrive?
Who	Who is used when asking for identity of person: Who called earlier?
Whose	Whose is used when asking about possession: Whose place are you staying at?
Where	Where is used when asking for the place: Where do you live?
Which	Which is used to ask about choice: Which one do you like?
Why	Why is used when asking for reason: Why did you break the glass?
How	How is used when asking procedure or method:

Synonyms and Antonyms:

Synonyms: Synonyms are those words or expressions that have the same meaning or nearly the same meaning in the same language. For example—liberty, liberation, freedom, independence and emancipation are all synonyms of each other.

Antonyms: Antonyms are those words or expressions that have the opposite meaning. For example—the antonym of 'independence' is 'dependence'.

Synonyms and antonyms of any language not only enrich the language but also accelerate its natural flow. By the use of synonyms one can avoid the boring repetition of any word or expression. Synonyms and antonyms can also enhance one's vocabulary knowledge of a language.

Synonyms and Antonyms of some important words:

1. **ABANDON (v)**—to leave: He abandoned his wife and children.

Synonyms: abdicate, leave, quit, desert, and discard.

Antonyms: chase, follow, undertake, and accept

2. **ACCUMULATE (v)**—to assemble—He is gradually accumulating courage to do the work.

Synonyms: assemble, gather, collect, store, hoard, congregate, rally. Antonyms: disperse, scatter, spread, dissipate, distribute

3. **ADVERSE (adj.)**—unfavorable: He made some adverse comments on my proposal.

Synonyms: antagonistic, unfavorable, critical, hostile, negative, unkind, censorious.

Antonyms: favorable, propitious, appropriate, advantageous, congenial.

4. ALARMING (Adj.) –ominous: Our population is increasing at an alarming rate.

Synonyms: frightful, terrible, fearful, ominous

Antonyms: hopeful, bright, auspicious

5. ANIMOSITY (n.) –hostility: There is no animosity between them.

Synonyms: enmity, hostility, antagonism, aversion, antipathy, acrimony, grudge, Resentment, vindictiveness.

6. BANKRUPT (adj.) –ruined: The company became bankrupt for incurring a heavy loss.

Synonyms: insolvent, destitute, indigent, ruined. Antonyms: rich, well-off, solvent, prosperous

7. BARREN (adj.) –unproductive: Crops do not grow in a barren land.

Synonyms: infertile, unproductive, sterile, bleak

Antonyms: fertile, productive

8. BENEFICIAL (adj.) –useful: Exercising is beneficial to health.

Synonyms: useful, helpful, valuable, positive.

Antonyms: useless, harmful, and detrimental.

9. BENEVOLENT (adj.) –kind: Our teacher is a benevolent person.

Synonyms: kind, altruistic, beneficent, charitable, philanthropic, generous, good.

Antonyms: spiteful, selfish, greedy, mean, malevolent, unkind.

10. CANDID (adj.) –frank: He made a candid confession.

Synonyms: frank, open, sincere, straightforward, outspoken, honest, sincere, truthful.

Antonyms: reserved, insincere, enigmatic, and mysterious.

11. CAPRICIOUS (adj.) –whimsical: We should give up our capricious behavior.

Synonyms: fickle, changeful, whimsical, fanciful, freakish, inconsistent, and flexible.

Antonyms: firm, rigid, constant, inflexible.

12. COMPULSORY (adj.) –mandatory: English is a compulsory subject at the secondary level.

Synonyms: obligatory, mandatory, coercive

Antonyms: optional, voluntary, charitable

13. COMPLACENT (adj.) –satisfied: She had a complacent smile on his face.

Synonyms: pleased, satisfied, content, happy, smug, content Antonyms:

dissatisfied, unhappy, discontented, anxious

14. CONDUCTIVE (adj.) –helpful: Fresh air is conducive to health. Synonyms:

effective, productive, good, useful, promotive, beneficial, contributive

Antonyms: repugnant, preventive, counteractive, destructive, bad, injurious, harmful.

15. CONSPICUOUS (adj.) –easily visible: His honesty is conspicuous.

Synonyms: distinguished, manifest, visible, prominent, famous, noticeable, observable

Antonyms: obs

16. DELIBERATE (adj.) –willful: Deliberate mistakes should be punished.

Synonyms: intentional, willful, planned, conscious, purposeful, premeditated

Antonyms: unintentional, inadvertent, unwilling, unwitting

17. DESIRABLE (adj.) –proper: Such an act of stupidity is not desirable from you.

Synonyms: acceptable, proper, suitable, advisable

Antonyms: objectionable, undesirable, improper, evil, unadvisable

18. DESTROY (v.) –to ruin: He has destroyed all the documents.

Synonyms: annihilate, ruin, obliterate, demolish, undo, subvert, overthrow, devastate

Antonyms: build, construct, create, repair, make

19. DILIGENT (adj.) –industrious: She is very diligent.

Synonyms: active, industrious, hardworking, assiduous, attentive

Antonyms: indolent, lazy, and idle.

20. ENCOURAGE (v.) –to inspire: My father always encourages me to help others.

Synonyms: incite, stimulate, urge, impel, inspire. Antonyms: prevent, discourage, dissuade, deter, dishearten.

21. ENTHUSIASM (n.) –zeal: She has great enthusiasm for music.

Synonyms: ardor, passion, eagerness, rapture, interest, keenness, fervor, gusto, zest

Antonyms: contempt, indifference, callousness, coldness, repugnance, cure, invisible, inconspicuous.

22. FASCINATE (v.) –to attract: She was fascinated by the beauty of the scenery.

Synonyms: charm, attract, captivate, enthrall, affect, mesmerize, absorb

Antonyms: bore, irritate, disturb, disgust

23. FATAL (adj.) –deadly: I saw a fatal accident.

Synonyms: mortal, deadly, destructive, dangerous, calamitous, harmful, serious, grave

Antonyms: harmless, wholesome, notorious, constructive, beneficial

24. FEEBLE (adj.) –weak: He is a man of feeble mind.

Synonyms: faint, weak, vain, frail, scanty, forceless,

nerveless. Antonyms: strong, robust, active, vigorous, muscular

25. FERGALLANT (adj.) – brave: He was a gallant soldier.

Synonyms: bold, brave, courageous, valiant, heroic, fearless, chivalrous. Antonyms: cowardly, timid, churlish, and fearful

26. GENEROUS (adj.) –kind: We should always be generous to poor people.

Synonyms: liberal, lavish, kind, bountiful, cordial, magnanimous, open- hearted

Antonyms: mean, niggardly, miserly, churlish, selfish, closefisted

27. GORGEOUS (adj.) – grand: We had a gorgeous party last night.

Synonyms: pompous, grand, magnificent, splendid, superb, costly

Antonyms: cheap, simple, colourless, threadbare, dingy

28. HAPHAZARD (adj.) – chaotic: Everything in the room was in a haphazard condition.

Synonyms: chaotic, confusing, disorderly, unsystematic, and unmethodical

Antonyms: organized, systematic, planned, methodical

29. HAZARD (n.) – risk: No business is free from hazard.

Synonyms: peril, risk, danger, jeopardy

Antonyms: safety, security, protection, certainty

30. HINDER (v.) – to impede: Nothing can hinder the expression of truth.

Synonyms: retard, debar, embarrass, impede, thwart, block, prevent, interrupt.

Antonyms: enable, promote, expedite, facilitate, accelerate.

31. IGNOBLE (adj.) – shameful: He has done an ignoble job.

Synonyms: mean, base, detestable, shameful, dishonorable,

Antonyms: exalted, lofty, grand, eminent, illustrious, brilliant, notable

32. IMPEDIMENT (n) – obstacle: Illiteracy is the impediment to success.

Synonyms: block, hindrance, obstacle, obstruction

Antonyms: support, succor, aid, help, assistance

33. KNOWLEDGEABLE (adj.) – learned: He is a very knowledgeable person.

Synonyms: educated, learned, experienced, intelligent, scholarly

Antonyms: ignorant, uneducated, unaware, foolish, stupid, inexperienced

34. LACONIC (adj.) – reticent: I like a laconic person.

Synonyms: curt, terse, epigrammatic, and reticent

Antonyms: wordy, garrulous, eloquent, and circumlocutory

35. LANGUID (adj.) – spiritless: I saw his languid body on the floor.

Synonyms: spiritless, exhausted, flagging, pining, drooping

Antonyms: active, strong, healthy, robust, vigorous

36. MODESTY (n.) – politeness: Everybody is impressed by his modesty.

Synonyms: humility, purity, bashfulness, politeness, diffidence, sobriety

Antonyms: vanity, conceit, effrontery, shamelessness, wantonness

37. MUSTY (adj.) – stale: Your ideas are all musty.

Synonyms: stale, outdated, obsolete, fetid, rank, fusty, mildewed

Antonyms: balmy, fresh, odorous, fragrant, aromatic

38. NAUGHTY (adj.) – bad: He is a naughty boy.

Synonyms: bad, wicked, disobedient, mischievous, roguish, wayward

Antonyms: good, mild, polite, obedient, well-behaved

39. NEBULOUS (adj.) – vague: There is a nebulous difference between the two ideas.

Synonyms: ambiguous, cloudy, hazy, imprecise, indistinct, misty, obscure

Antonyms: clear, certain, precise, distinct, bright

40. OBSCENE (adj.) – dirty: I don't like obscene jokes.

Synonyms: bawdy, coarse, indecent, filthy, foul, gross, lewd, licentious, offensive

Antonyms: clean, decent, decorous, wholesome, pure

41. OBSOLETE (adj.) – out-date: Give up your obsolete plans.
Synonyms: old, ancient, out-dated, outmoded, outworn, old-fashioned
Antonyms: current, new, modern, up-to-date, contemporary
42. PACIFY (v.) – to appease: The mother is pacifying her crying baby.
Synonyms: calm down, soothe, appease, tranquilize, mollify, placate
Antonyms: excite, irritate, rouse, exasperate, agitate, provoke,
43. SOLITARY (adj.) – lonely: He lives a solitary life.
Synonyms: lonely, isolated, secluded, deserted, and uninhabited
Antonyms: populous, social, inhabited, well-frequented.
44. TANGIBLE (adj.) – manifest: There is not tangible evidence of his crime.
Synonyms: actual, real, definite, manifest, evident, concrete, positive, substantial.
Antonyms: intangible, abstract, indefinite, unreal, negative, untouchable
45. UNANIMOUS (adj.) – concerted: They reached a unanimous decision on the matter.
Synonyms: common, concerted, harmonious, joint, united
Antonyms: discordant, divided, disunited, split
46. VACATE (v.) – to leave: The police asked the people to vacate the place.
Synonyms: leave, quit, abandon, withdraw, desert, evacuate
Antonyms: occupy, capture, enter, fill, and take
47. WEAKEN (v.) – to decline: The disease has weakened his body.
Synonyms: dilute, impair, paralyze, debilitate, enfeeble
Antonyms: empower, confirm, strengthen, invigorate
48. ZENITH (n.) – peak: He has reached the zenith of his fame.
Synonyms: acme, climax, height, peak, summit, top, vertex
Antonyms: nadir, bottom, depth, lowest point.

Answer the following questions:

1. Examine the significance and appropriateness of the title of the story.

Ans: The author O'Henry has appropriately chosen the title 'The Gift of the Magi' for the story of Della and Jim. The Magi were the three Wisemen - Gaspar, Melchior, and Balthazar who traveled from the East to Jerusalem to see the infant Jesus born in a stable. They were guided by a star and they carried precious gifts for Jesus. The Magi invented the tradition of giving gifts on Christmas. Being wise, their gifts were also undoubtedly wise.

The story centers around a young couple Della and Jim who are poor but hardworking and their existence is full of struggle but they manage to experience joy through the power of their love for each other. They planned to make Christmas eve a special one with a wonderful gift for each other. Jim and Della had to sell off their precious possessions to buy gifts for each other on Christmas. Della in order to have a fine, rare, and sterling gift for Jim sold her long and beautiful hair. Finally, she bought a platinum fob chain, simple and chaste in design, for Jim's gold watch. On the other hand, Jim sold his precious gold watch to buy an expensive tortoise shell comb for Della's

beautiful hair.

But the gifts of Della and Jim are unique and wise in the sense that they reveal the true essence of gift-giving on Christmas, i.e. selflessness and a desire to add the happiness of the one who receives the gift and the spirit of sacrifice. Through O' Henry terms the couple as 'the foolish children' he points out clearly that they value the human relationship and their mutual love and generosity make them the 'Magi'. Thus the title is quite significant and appropriate.

2. Based on the events, attempt a justification of the story as an example of comic irony.

Ans: In 'The Gift of the Magi' the author O' Henry uses comic irony with a view to emphasizing the moral of the story. Jim and Della, two key characters of the story, had to sell off their precious possessions to buy gifts for each other on Christmas. Della in order to afford a rare and sterling gift for Jim sold her long and beautiful hair. Finally, she bought a platinum fob chain, simple and chaste in design, for Jim's gold watch. On the other hand, Jim sold his precious gold watch to buy an expensive tortoiseshell comb for Della's beautiful hair.

The ironic twist in the story is that both Della and Jim sold off the very treasure each possessed for which the gifts were meant. A faint smile spread across the lips of the reader with this ironic twist in the plot. But this irony makes the story of Jim and Della a moral lesson that selflessness and a desire to add the happiness of the one who receives the gift and the spirit of sacrifice is the essence of gift-giving on Christmas.

3. What moral lessons are stressed in "The Gift of the Magi"?

Ans: The story 'The Gift of The Magi' deals with the moral lesson of what constitutes the true spirit of gift-giving on Christmas. Both Jim and Della were poor, so they had to sell off their most prized possession to buy Christmas gifts for each other. Della sacrificed her long lustrous hair beautiful enough to make the queen of Sheba envy her while Jim sacrificed his golden watch, a family heirloom. Jim brought a set of tortoiseshell combs for Della, which she had ever longed for, but it was too nice for her to use. She told her long hair to buy a platinum fob chain for Jim's watch. Even Della's gift for Jim was too nice to be used. Both Jim and Della sacrificed their most cherished possession to buy something for the use of the other's most cherished possession. Here lies the true spirit of gift-giving on Christmas.

4. Describe what Della does from the moment she decides to earn money for Jim's gift till the moment she earns it.

Ans: Della is very upset when it is the day before Christmas and she has only \$1.87 together beloved Jim a Christmas gift. She decided the only way to get more money is to sell the most important thing to her, her very long hair. She goes to Madame Saffronie's hair shop and is offered \$20 for her hair. She sells her hair to Madame Saffronie and goes to get Jim a gold chain for his most important possession his watch. He currently kept it on a leather strap, and she knew he would be ecstatic to open his gift. She starts to get very nervous and afraid that Jim will not think she is pretty with her new hair.

MCQ:

1. Della's hair and Jim's watch have always been a source of []
(a) Pride (b) angry (c) nervousness (D) All of these
2. Della buys a _____ for \$20 that is just perfect for Jim. It was simple and chaste in design. []
(a) Platinum watch chain (b) gold chain (b) silver chain (b) gold chain
3. The story uses the literary device known as a situational twist in plot that the reader may not guess or expect. []
(a) Climax (b) dialogue (c) irony (d) metaphor
4. What is the central theme of this story? []
(a) Unconditional love (b) hatred (c) sacrifice (d) sympathy
5. How much money had Della saved for? []
(a) \$1.87 (b) \$2.17 (c) \$2.0 (d) \$2.13
6. When is Skimming NOT required? []
(a) Reading (b) Reviewing (c) Pre-reading (d) Recalling
7. Looking for a number in your phone is an example of _____. []
(a) Intensive (b) Extensive (c) Skimming (d) Scanning
8. Looking through a Google search list is an example of _____. []
(a) Intensive (b) Extensive (c) Skimming (d) Scanning
9. Skimming is a type of _____. []
(a) Writing (b) reading (c) speaking (d) listening
10. Skimming means reading quickly to know _____. []
(a) What is it about (b) specific piece of information
(c) full understanding of text (d) none of the above?
11. Scanning means reading quickly to know: []
(a) What is it about (b) specific piece of information
(c) full understanding of text (d) all of the above
12. A dictionary consultation is: []
(a) Skimming (b) Scanning (c) Extensive (d) Intensive
13. The first page in the newspaper []
(a) Skimming (b) Scanning (c) Extensive (d) Intensive
14. The pen name of Sydney William Porter []
(a) O. Henry (b) O. William (c) O. Sydney (d) O. Moor
15. O. Henry's surprise endings is also called as []

(a)O.Henrytwist(b)O.Henrysurprise(c)O.Henryendings(d)O.Henry confusion

16. Therootword'Graph'means----- []

(a)Write (b)read (c)speak (d)listen

17. Therootwordinunbelievable []

(a)Believe (b)believable (c)unbelieve (d)Noneofthese

18. Mymotheriscookingdeliciousfooditems.Heretheunderlinedwordcan bereplacedby- []

(a)Bland (b)insipid (c)tasty (d)good

19. Weshouldcancelourtrip.Heretheunderlinedwordcanbe replacedby- []

(a)Allow (b)abolish (c)create (d)none

20. ThewordantonymofGENUINE []

a) Spurious b)plutonic c)innocent d)real

21. ThewordantonymofAccomplish []

a) Disagreeable b)Fail c)Scatter d)Improper



9. Assignments

S. No	Question	BL	CO
1	Definereadingskillsandwritereadingtechniqueswithexamples.	1	1
2	Whatmorallessonsarestressedin"TheGiftoftheMagi"?	1	1
3	Summarizetheshortstory"TheGiftoftheMagi"inyourownwords.	2	4

PartBQuestions

S.No	Question	BL	CO
1	Discuss thesignificance andappropriateness of the title ofthestory'TheGiftofMagi'.	2	1
2	Basedontheevents,attemptajustificationofthe story as an example of comic irony	3	1
3	Whatmorallessonsarestressedin"TheGiftofthe Magi"?	1	1
4	DescribewhatDelladoesfromthemomentshedecides toearnmoneyforJim'sgifttillthe momentsheearnsit.	2	1
5	Explain how loveand affection between Della and Jimshownintheshortstory'TheGiftofMagi'.	2	1

10. SUPPORTIVEONLINECERTIFICATIONCOURSES

NPTEL

11. REALTIMEAPPLICATIONS

S. No	Application	CO
1	Exposure to language in formal & informal situations	1
2	Mechanics of Writing	2

12. Contents Beyond the Syllabus

1. Idiomatic Expressions and Phrasal Verbs.
2. Tenses.
3. Degrees of Comparison.

13. Prescribed Text Books & Reference Books

Text Book

1. Pathfinder: Communicative English for Undergraduate Students - I Edition 2023, Orient Black Swan.

References:

1. Bailey, Stephen. Academic writing: A Handbook for International Students, Routledge, 2014.
2. Chase, Becky Tarver. Pathways: Listening, Speaking and Critical Thinking, Henley ELT; 2nd Edition, 2018.
3. Raymond Murphy's English Grammar in Use, Fourth Edition (2012) Ebook.
4. Hewing, Martin. Cambridge Academic English (B2). CUP, 2012.
5. Oxford Learners Dictionary, 12th Edition, 2011.
6. Norman Lewis Word Power Made Easy - The Complete Handbook for Building a Superior Vocabulary Goyal Reprinted edition 2011.